4) To forge as many mutually advantageous links as possible and get Bangladesh more and more involved with India.

While thinking about the Chinese, Pakistani and the USA penetration in the post-Mujib era, India was also deliberating its ties with the Soviet Union as far as Bangladesh was concerned. There was a unanimous feeling within the establishment that the Soviet capacity to do anything in Bangladesh on a major scale was limited. Yet, at the same time, any sizeable Soviet presence in Bangladesh could evoke extraordinarily sharp reactions in Washington and Beijing. A note drafted by intelligence officers and diplomats said:

Our interest should lie in keeping Bangladesh as much as possible as a sub-continental or South Asian affair. This cannot be achieved if India is too much identified with the Soviet Union in Bangladesh. In those circumstances, India's capacity to divide US, China and Pakistan will be completely nullified. The Soviet Union has to be persuaded to play second fiddle in Bangladesh and whatever understanding is arrived at with them should not be manifested publicly. It should be kept in mind except for a small number of people who are ideologically committed to Pakistan, China, US and Soviet Union, the overwhelming majority of the people of Bangladesh would not like to see their country transformed into a battleground of big powers and to be devastated once again. This fear should be fully exploited by India and this cannot be done effectively if India is too much identified with the Soviet Union in Bangladesh. At the same time, it must be stressed that this policy would not succeed if there were slightest indications of 'hegemonistic tendencies' on the part of India. One of the major efforts of Indian diplomacy in Dhaka should be to overcome the